NICHOLSON LIVING APP · IPHONE, ANDROID AND WEB

# Your home, *in your pocket.*

Nicholson Living is the official app for Nicholson Lettings residents. Report repairs, message the engineer booked on your repair, see your rent account, keep your tenancy documents, message us and book extra services, all in one place and open 24 hours a day. Once the app is live, it is how we talk to you and how you talk to us.

- Free to download
- Sign in with a one-time code
- Every message saved to your account
- Repairs tracked from report to completion
- Message your engineer directly

## OUR APPROACH Why we built it

> We have been landlords since 2008. In that time the thing residents have asked of us most is simple: tell me where things stand.

Nicholson Group has spent nearly two decades restoring buildings and letting homes across St Helens and Liverpool. Over that time we have listened to residents in person, in surveys and in reviews. The feedback was clear. Our homes are good, but reporting a repair and hearing back took too long, and updates depended on who you happened to reach.

We have rebuilt the service around you. Every repair is logged, given a job number and timed against a target. Every message is answered professionally and saved to your account. You can see your rent, your documents and your building notices whenever you want, without waiting for office hours.

The app also gives you and us the same written record. If there is ever a question about what was reported, when, and what was done, the answer is in the app.

**STAFF TIP**

Use this section in your own words when a resident asks why we have moved to the app. Lead with the benefit to them: speed, a clear record and access at any time. Do not describe it as a cost-saving or a way to avoid phone calls.

| BEFORE | WITH NICHOLSON LIVING |
| --- | --- |
| Repairs reported by email or form, with no reference | Repair logged in seconds with a job number |
| Chasing the office for an update | Notified when the engineer is booked and when the job is closed |
| No way to reach the engineer | Message the engineer on your repair; they reply by 5pm the same working day |
| No record of what was done | Told what was done, by whom, and asked whether you are happy |
| Documents scattered across emails | Tenancy agreement, inventory, deposit and safety certificates in one place |
| Replies depended on who answered | Every reply polite, professional and saved to your account |
| Office hours only | Open 24 hours, with tap-to-call emergency cover day and night |

## 5 MINUTES Getting started

1. **Download Nicholson Living**
   Search “Nicholson Living” in the App Store (iPhone) or Google Play (Android). The seller is Nicholson Lettings Limited. No smartphone? Use the web version at living.nicholsongroup.co.uk.

2. **Enter the email address we hold for you**
   Use the email on your tenancy. If you have changed it, tell us first so we can update your account.

3. **Type in your sign-in code**
   We email you a one-time code from nicholsongroup.co.uk. There is no password to remember. Check your junk folder if it has not arrived within a few minutes.

4. **Read our Service with Respect message**
   The app is here for your convenience. We ask everyone, residents and staff alike, to keep every message polite and courteous. Read the full commitment at nicholsonlettings.com/service-with-respect.

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### Allow notifications

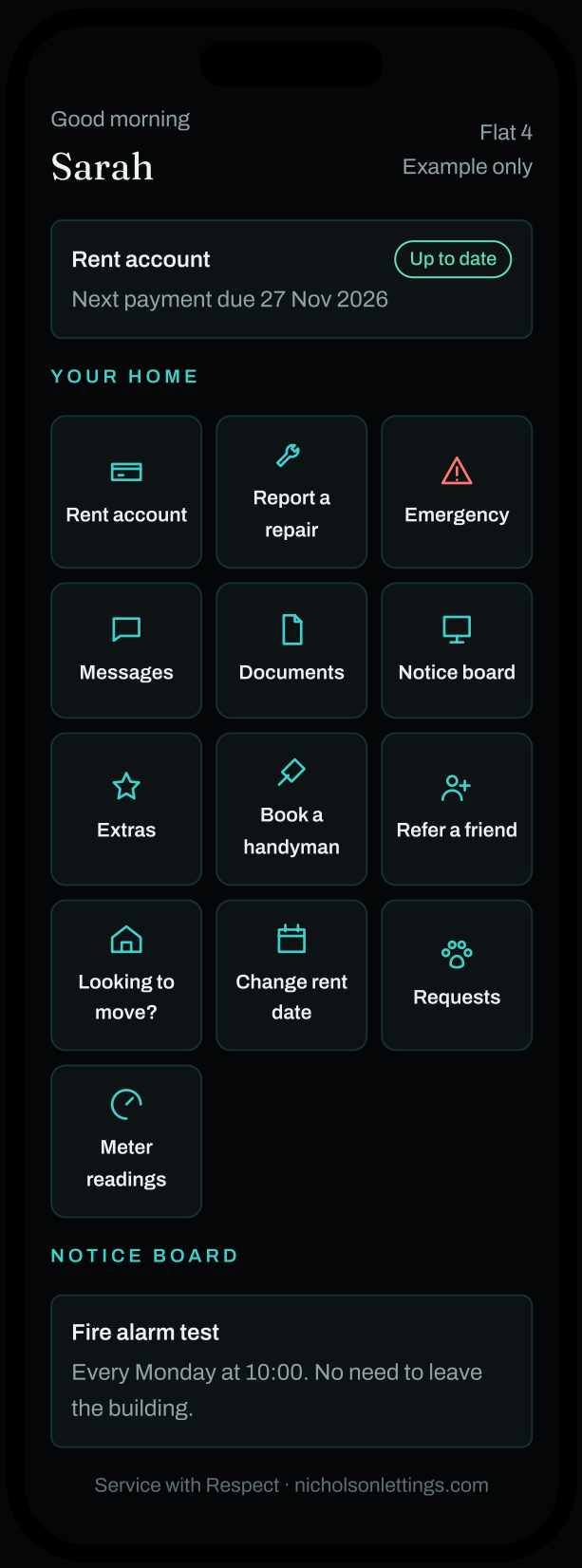
This is how we tell you an engineer is booked, a job is complete, an inspection is due or a notice has been posted for your building.

**STAFF TIP**

Before launch we need an up-to-date email and mobile number for every resident. Confirm both whenever you speak to a resident and pass any change to the office the same day. A wrong email means the resident cannot sign in.

AT A GLANCE

# Your home screen




**Rent account**

Payments due and received, Pay now, I've paid and payment plans.

**Report a repair**

Log a repair, get a job number and track it to completion.

**Emergency**
Tap to call our engineer, day or night.

**Messages**
Your conversation with us, saved on your account.

**Documents**
Tenancy agreement, inventory, deposit and safety certificates.

**Notice board**
Building notices, planned works and inspections.

**Extras**
Early check-in, late check-out, cleaning and more.

**Book a handyman**
Small jobs around your home that are not repairs.

**Refer a friend**
£50 when a friend you refer moves in.

**Looking to move?**
Move to another Nicholson home free, no holding deposit.

**Change rent date**
Move your payment date, free, with our consent.

**Requests**
Pets, authorised occupiers and tenancy admin.

**Meter readings**
Submit gas, electric and water readings.

REPORT · TRACK · CONFIRM

# Repairs

Report every repair through the app, however small. A report in the app is the official record, so it is the fastest way to get it fixed and the only way to make sure nothing is missed.

1. **Tap Report a repair**
   Choose where the problem is: kitchen, bathroom, bedroom, living room or a communal area.

2. **Describe what is wrong**
   Be specific. “Kitchen tap dripping constantly” gets the right engineer with the right parts first time.

3. **Choose access**
   Let us use management keys, or tell us you will be home. We confirm the arrangement back to you.

4. **Get your job number**
   The job is logged straight away with a reference, for example J1051, and appears in your repairs history.

5. **We book the engineer**
   You are notified when the job is booked on our maintenance calendar.

6. **Message your engineer**
   Once an engineer is booked, your repair shows **Message [engineer's first name]**. Use it for arrival times, access and anything they need from you. They reply by 5pm the same working day (the next working day if you message after 5pm or at the weekend).

7. **Job completed and closed**
   You are told what was done and which engineer did it, then asked for your feedback. If the job is not right, say so and it goes straight back on the list.

| PRIORITY | TARGET | EXAMPLES |
|---|---|---|
| Emergency | 2 days | Danger to health or safety, or serious damage to the building. Call the emergency line as well. |
| Reactive | 14 days | Something that stops part of your home working properly, such as a faulty appliance or a leaking tap. |

| PRIORITY | TARGET | EXAMPLES |
|---|---|---|
| Inconvenience | 28 days | Minor defects that do not affect how you use your home, such as a sticking drawer or loose trim. |

**STAFF TIP**

Never log a repair for a resident by text, WhatsApp or a verbal promise. Walk them through reporting it in the app, or report it in the staff console on their behalf so the job number and timer start. If a resident rejects a completed job, it returns to the open list and keeps its history. Once you are booked on a repair, the resident can message you; reply in NicoNet › My jobs by 17:00 the same working day or Kevin is told.

DAY AND NIGHT

## Emergencies

**Smell gas? Fire? Call these first.**

Leave the property if it is unsafe. Then report it to us.

GAS EMERGENCY
0800 111 999

FIRE, POLICE, AMBULANCE
999

NICHOLSON EMERGENCY ENGINEER
Tap Emergency in the app

### Use the emergency engineer for

- Flooding or a major leak
- No heating or hot water
- A break-in or an insecure door or window
- Being locked out

### How it works

The Emergency tile connects you straight to our engineer, who is on call 24 hours a day. The number is not shown; just tap to call.

### Locked out

£100 call-out

We will let you back in. The call-out is paid through a secure payment link.

**STAFF TIP**

Do not give out the emergency engineer's number. Residents reach it through the Emergency tile only.

ALWAYS CURRENT

# Rent account

Your rent account shows every payment due, its amount and whether it has been received. It is updated as payments arrive.

## Pay now

Shows the landlord company's bank details for your tenancy and your payment reference, with copy buttons. Always use your reference so we can match the payment.

## I've paid

Paid by bank transfer? Tell us the date, amount and the name on the paying account. We check it, usually by the next working day, and notify you once it has cleared.

## Payment plan

Fallen behind? Request a plan in the app. We reply in Messages within 2 working days. Your normal rent stays due on time, and the full balance stays due until a plan is agreed.

## Build your credit score

Sign up to Brickk from the app and your on-time rent payments can help improve your credit file.

**If your account is in arrears or a damage invoice is unpaid,** the app shows a flashing alert and sends a notification. Extras, handyman bookings, referrals, moves and requests are paused until the balance is cleared. Repairs, emergencies, your rent account, messages, documents and the notice board always stay open.

STAFF TIP

If a resident says they have paid, ask them to use I've paid in the app rather than telling you verbally. That puts the claim on record for the accounts team to verify.

ONE PLACE

# Documents and certificates

## Your tenancy

- Signed tenancy agreement
- Holding deposit confirmation
- Inventory
- DPS deposit certificate (where you paid a cash deposit)

## Certificates tab

- Gas safety certificate
- Electrical installation report
- Energy Performance Certificate (EPC)

## What you upload

Photo ID, and right to rent documents where they apply. Upload them once and they are held securely on your account.

ON RECORD

# Messages, notices and updates

## Messages

Ask us anything. Every message and reply is saved on your account, so nothing gets lost and you never have to explain twice.

## Message your engineer

On an open repair with an engineer booked, tap **Message [first name]**. You see the engineer's first name and they see yours; phone numbers are never exchanged. Nicholson Lettings can read every message and will step in if a reply is late. The conversation closes when the repair is completed and stays on your record.

## Notice board

Building notices, such as weekly fire alarm tests, planned works and communal cleaning.

## Inspections

We inspect each building on a rolling programme. You get written notice in the app before any visit.

## Resident newsletter

Monthly: new residents, how our maintenance team is performing, planned works, new homes and app improvements.

| YOU WANT TO | USE | WHO ANSWERS |
|---|---|---|
| **Report something broken** | Report a repair | Our maintenance team, with a job number and target date |
| **Ask about a repair that is booked** | Message [engineer] on that repair | The engineer, by 5pm the same working day |
| **Anything else about your home or tenancy** | Messages | Nicholson Lettings, signed “Nicholson Lettings” |
| **An emergency** | The Emergency tile | Our on-call engineer, day or night |

**Please use the app, not email or phone, for everything about your tenancy.** Correspondence through the app is logged automatically, which protects you if there is ever a dispute. Please keep every message polite, as Service with Respect sets out; we ask the same of our team.

STAFF TIP

Engineers answer residents in NicoNet › My jobs, by 17:00 the same working day. Never give a resident your own phone number or take theirs. The office reads every conversation in NicoMGT › Maintenance and can reply as “Nicholson office”. Anything not about the booked repair belongs in Messages, which comes to the office.

## OPTIONAL Extras and services

Book and pay for extra services in the app. Payment is taken securely through the Nicholson Lettings online store.

| SERVICE | WHAT YOU GET |
|---|---|
| **Early check-in** | Move in before our standard 3pm to 5pm check-in slot. |
| **Late check-out** | Leave after our standard 11:00am check-out on your last day. |
| **Cleaning** | A professional clean of your home. |
| **Book a Handyman** | Small jobs that are not repairs, such as hanging pictures, shelves or flat-pack assembly. |
| **Refresh My Home** | A refresh of your home during your tenancy. |
| **Remove Furniture to Storage** | We take supplied furniture you do not need into storage. One-off charge. |

| SERVICE | WHAT YOU GET |
| --- | --- |
| **Upgrade My Move In** | An upgraded move-in experience. |

ASK US

## Requests

### Looking to move?

See every Nicholson home available now. Existing residents move to another Nicholson property free of charge, with no holding deposit.

### Refer a friend

£50

Paid to you by bank transfer once your friend's tenancy is successful and they have moved in.

### Change your rent date

Ask to move your payment date. Free of charge, with our consent.

### Pet consent

We are pet friendly. Ask before a pet moves in so we can confirm in writing.

### Authorised occupier

Ask before someone else lives with you. An authorised occupier has permission to live there but does not have tenancy rights.

### Meter readings

Submit readings at move-in, at move-out or whenever your supplier asks.

ADMIN

## Your tenancy

### Giving notice

Notice is given in the app under Requests. It can be given on your contractual rent payment date once that month's rent has been received, or on the day your rent is marked received if it arrived on the rent date. You can request a landlord reference at the same time.

### Check-out

Check-out is at 11:00am on the last day of your tenancy. Late check-out can be booked as an extra.

### After you leave

Your app account is closed 14 days after your tenancy ends. Save copies of your documents before then.

STAFF TIP

Do not raise notice with residents or point them to it. Answer the rule accurately if asked. If a resident mentions moving, tell them about Looking to move? first.

## SUPPORT Help

| | |
|---|---|
| **My sign-in code has not arrived** | Check junk or spam for an email from nicholsongroup.co.uk. Make sure you used the email on your tenancy. If you have changed email address, contact us so we can update it. |
| **A tile is greyed out with a padlock** | Your account has an unpaid balance. Use Pay now, I've paid or Payment plan on the alert at the top of the screen. The tile unlocks once the balance is cleared. |
| **My engineer hasn't replied** | Engineers reply by 5pm the same working day (the next working day if you wrote after 5pm or at the weekend). If they haven't, we are alerted automatically and will reply to you ourselves. |
| **I have no smartphone** | Use the web version at living.nicholsongroup.co.uk on any computer or tablet. |
| **I can't get into the app at all** | Call Nicholson Lettings on 0151 475 5042 and we will help you sign in. |
| **I want to leave a review** | We read every review. Find us on Trustpilot: uk.trustpilot.com/review/www.nicholsonlettings.com |

FOR THE TEAM

# Teaching residents the app

Every member of staff who meets residents is expected to know this guide and to show residents how to use the app. Share this page with the staff tips switched on so they appear in every section.

## On move-in day

- Before you show them the building, have them download Nicholson Living and sign in with you there.
- Open Documents together and point out the tenancy agreement, inventory and certificates.
- Walk through Report a repair, show where Message [engineer] appears once a job is booked, then show where the Emergency tile is.
- Turn on notifications on their phone.

## The three messages to land

- Report every repair in the app. It gets a job number and a target date.
- Everything about the tenancy goes through the app, so there is always a record.
- Once a repair is booked, they can message the engineer directly in the app.
- Emergencies are covered day and night through the Emergency tile.

## Do

- Keep every reply polite and professional, as Service with Respect sets out.
- Redirect texts, calls and emails to the app, kindly.
- Confirm the resident's email and mobile each time you speak.

## Don't

- Give out the emergency engineer's number, or your own.
- Promise a repair date outside the app.
- Bring up giving notice.
- Discuss a resident's arrears with anyone else.

| | |
|---|---|
| **“Why can't I just ring the office?”** | “You can always call for help getting into the app. For anything about your home, the app is faster, it gives you a job number, and you can see the update yourself at any time.” |
| **“Is my information safe?”** | “Your account is personal to you, protected by a one-time sign-in code, and only Nicholson staff handling your tenancy can see it.” |
| **“Can I just text the engineer?”** | “Message them on your repair in the app instead. They reply by 5pm the same working day, and it's all on your record, so nothing gets lost.” |

| | |
|---|---|
| **“What if my repair isn't fixed properly?”** | “When it's closed, you'll be asked if you're happy. Tell us it isn't right and it goes straight back on the list with its history.” |